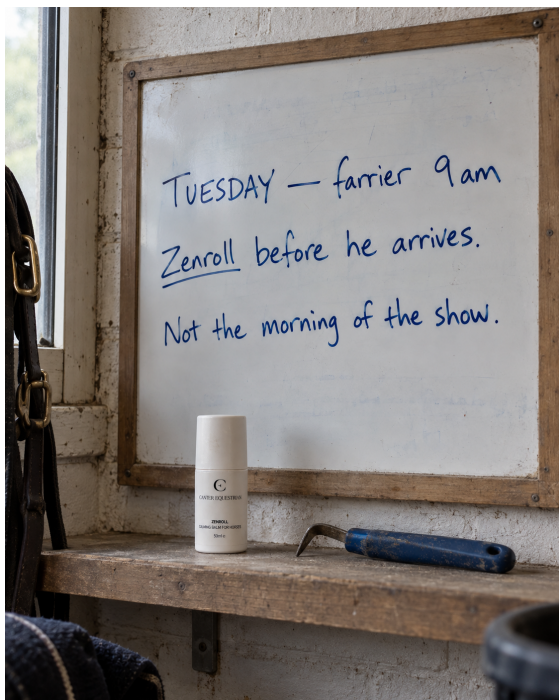


# Creative Strategy Work Sample

## ZENROLL / CANTER EQUESTRIAN

How I structure paid-social creative from strategy and controlled testing through execution, handoff and performance learning.



A powder in the feed.  
Or a scent on the nose.

| FED DAILY                      | USED WHEN NEEDED                    |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ✗ Loading week before it works | ✓ Apply on the day                  |
| ✗ Given every day              | ✓ Only for the moments that need it |
| ✗ Must be eaten                | ✓ Nothing goes into the horse       |
| ✗ Hope he finishes the bucket  | ✓ You see it applied                |

Scope: funnel strategy, hypotheses, concept banks, hook/copy variation, briefs, AI production direction, Meta copy and Ads Manager learning.

# My testing system: concept first, then controlled variation

I do not treat one ad as a complete test of an idea. Where the format allows it, each concept becomes a small creative bank - usually around five hook/copy variations - while the core angle and visual logic stay consistent.

That matters because one weak hook can make a strong concept look bad, while one unusually strong hook can make an average execution look better than it really is. I want enough variation to separate the performance of the concept, the visual and the copy.

|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. One hypothesis</b>       | Start with one customer insight, objection, situation or reason to care.                                                                                                               |
| <b>2. One concept / format</b> | Choose the visual system that expresses that hypothesis clearly.                                                                                                                       |
| <b>3. Around five hooks</b>    | Test different ways into the same idea - pain, proof, curiosity, objection, situation or benefit - where the format supports it.                                                       |
| <b>4. Build a small bank</b>   | Instead of one isolated ad, Meta gets multiple executions of the same core concept that different people can respond to.                                                               |
| <b>5. Read the pattern</b>     | Compare spend, CTR, CPC, CVR and ROAS across variants. If several hooks work, the angle has a stronger signal. If only one works, I keep learning before calling the concept a winner. |
| <b>6. Decide what failed</b>   | This helps define whether the issue is the angle itself, the creative execution, or the hook/copy - instead of killing an entire direction from one result.                            |

**The goal is not five ads for the sake of volume. It is enough controlled variation to learn what is actually driving performance and to avoid assuming that one winning sentence represents the whole market.**

# A-Z workflow

Once the testing logic is clear, this is how I build the work around it.

|                                        |                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>01 Understand</b>                   | Product, customer, offer, margins, markets, brand voice, funnel stage and previous winners/losers.                                                |
| <b>02 Research</b>                     | Customer language, reviews, competitor ads, Meta Ad Library, category patterns, objections and recurring situations.                              |
| <b>03 Build hypotheses</b>             | Turn research into specific things worth testing rather than a list of random formats.                                                            |
| <b>04 Develop concept banks</b>        | Choose the concept/format and build multiple hook/copy entries around the same core idea.                                                         |
| <b>05 Write execution-ready briefs</b> | Audience, funnel stage, message, hook variants, copy, visual logic, prompts/shot direction, safe zones and market adaptations.                    |
| <b>06 Handoff + QA</b>                 | Designers/editors/UGC creators execute; I review against the strategic idea and give specific edit notes.                                         |
| <b>07 Launch + analyse</b>             | I use Ads Manager to read spend, CTR, CPC, CPM, CVR and ROAS across the bank.                                                                     |
| <b>08 Iterate</b>                      | Scale/expand patterns that repeat, rework concepts where the angle is sound but execution is weak, and move on when the hypothesis does not hold. |

## What I personally own

Research, creative strategy, angle selection, concepts, hooks, copy, briefs, AI-production direction, testing structure and performance analysis. Production can be handed to designers, editors or UGC creators; I review the output and direct revisions.

# Funnel structure: what each wave is meant to learn

For Zenroll, I separated the work into distinct TOF hypotheses and then expanded MOF into multiple formats. The format is never the strategy by itself; it is the vehicle for a specific message.

|                                       |                                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>TOF - Proof</b>                    | Test whether evidence and plain-language proof stop the audience better than atmosphere.                                                         |
| <b>TOF - Situation</b>                | Test whether recognisable horse-owner moments create stronger relevance and attention.                                                           |
| <b>TOF - Safety &amp; Ingredients</b> | Test whether transparency around topical use, ingredients and format reduces hesitation.                                                         |
| <b>MOF - Expansion</b>                | Take validated or important messages and express them through comparison, education, problem-solution, listicle, benefit and contextual formats. |

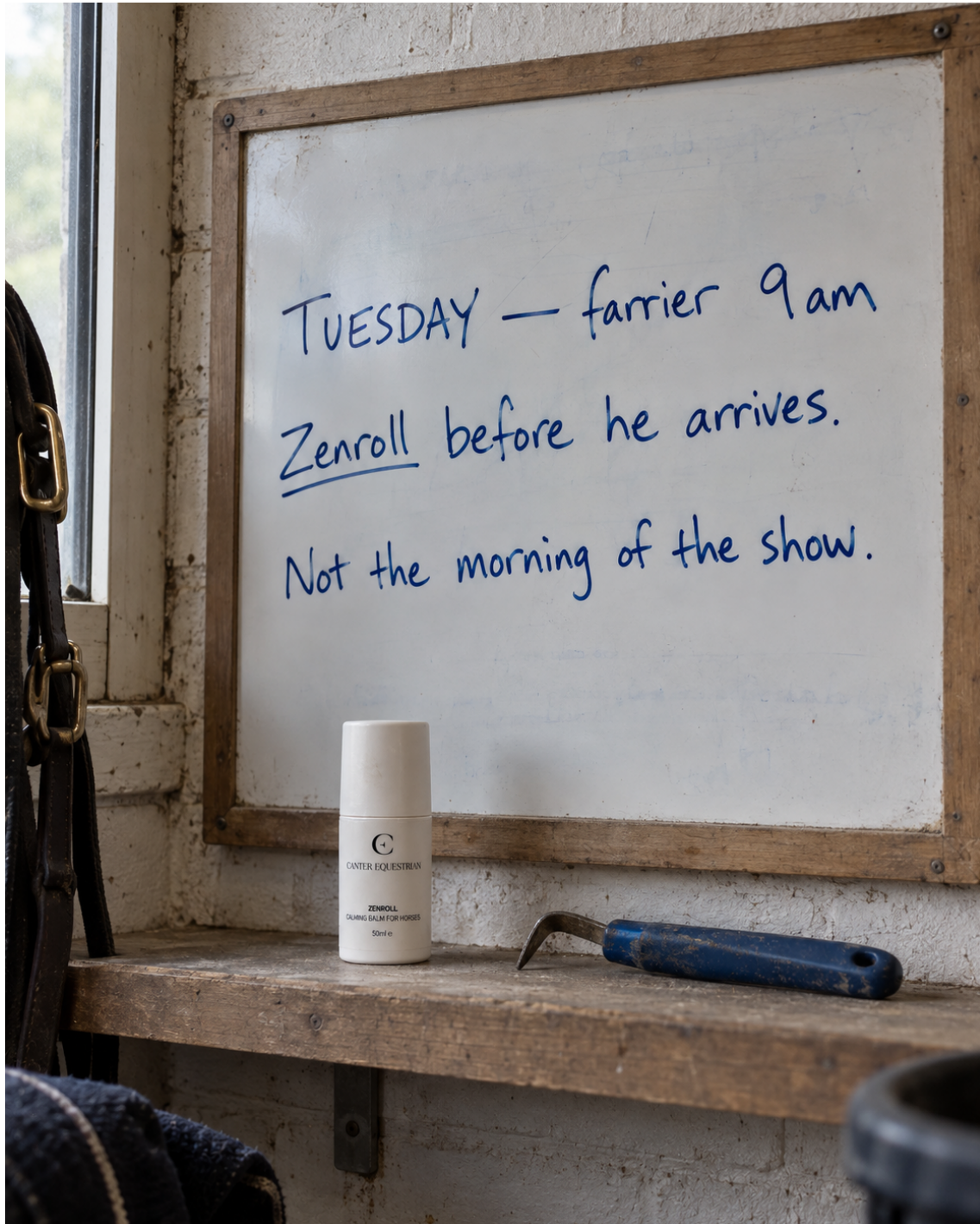
## Production rules

4:5 master format with 9:16 adaptations, safe zones, UK/US text layers, one dominant thought per static, documentary rather than glossy photography, and prompts that can work as AI-generation prompts or photographer shot briefs.

## Creative format example 1: Text in Context

Makes the ad feel like a real stable moment rather than a polished promotion. The message lives inside the scene itself.

This is one execution inside the concept. Where appropriate, I would pair the format with multiple hook/copy variations rather than judge the idea from this single version.



## Creative format example 2: Problem to Solution

Turns recognisable horse-owner situations into one clear idea: prepare before the difficult moment.

This is one execution inside the concept. Where appropriate, I would pair the format with multiple hook/copy variations rather than judge the idea from this single version.

# The farrier. The clippers. The first cold morning.



A stranger holding his foot



A noise he cannot place



A ramp that moves under him



The first sharp morning of autumn

## A better starting point.



## Creative format example 3: Features Point Out

Product-led education that makes ingredient transparency part of the selling argument.

This is one execution inside the concept. Where appropriate, I would pair the format with multiple hook/copy variations rather than judge the idea from this single version.



# Creative format example 4: Us vs Them

Compares Zenroll with the category rather than a named competitor, making the difference easy to scan.

This is one execution inside the concept. Where appropriate, I would pair the format with multiple hook/copy variations rather than judge the idea from this single version.

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## Creative format example 5: Listicle

A fast-scanning educational format built around observable signs instead of exaggerated promises.

This is one execution inside the concept. Where appropriate, I would pair the format with multiple hook/copy variations rather than judge the idea from this single version.

# Four things to watch for after you roll it on.

- 01 **Chewing**
- 02 **Licking**
- 03 **A yawn**
- 04 **The lower lip going soft**

He will tell you. You just have to be looking.



## Creative format example 6: Education Grid

Broadens relevance by showing multiple real situations where the audience can recognise their own horse.

This is one execution inside the concept. Where appropriate, I would pair the format with multiple hook/copy variations rather than judge the idea from this single version.

### Six moments that ask more of him.



**The trailer**



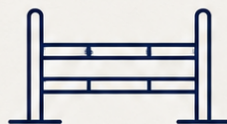
**The farrier**



**The clippers**



**First cold morning**



**A new arena**



**Box rest**

Zenroll · a calming balm for horses that works through scent.

## Creative format example 7: Benefit Stack

Compresses the proposition into one dominant thought with supporting reasons, designed for mobile reading.

This is one execution inside the concept. Where appropriate, I would pair the format with multiple hook/copy variations rather than judge the idea from this single version.



# Nothing daily.

-  Nothing goes into his feed
-  Already diluted, ready to use
-  Works through scent, not sedation
-  About one to three hours, reapply when needed

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Zenroll · 50 ml · 24.99 EUR

# Meta copy, performance reading and next decisions

I write the Meta-side copy separately from the visual brief: primary text, headline, description and CTA. This keeps the visual focused while allowing the ad unit to carry deeper explanation.

|                              |                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Attention problem</b>     | If the concept converts when people reach the site but CTR is weak, I test hooks/openings and visual execution.                               |
| <b>Conversion problem</b>    | If it earns clicks but CVR/ROAS is weak, I inspect message-to-offer alignment, objections and landing-page intent.                            |
| <b>Repeatable winner</b>     | If multiple hooks around the same concept perform, I treat that as a stronger signal and expand the bank.                                     |
| <b>Single-version winner</b> | If only one variation works, I do not immediately assume the whole angle is validated; I create more controlled variations to understand why. |
| <b>No signal</b>             | If neither the concept nor its variations improve after meaningful spend, I move to the next hypothesis rather than endlessly polishing it.   |

**Every creative should either produce performance or produce a useful learning that makes the next test better.**